

Behavioral Approach Description

Perspective

- Emphasizes the **behavior** of the leader
- Focuses exclusively on **what leaders do** and **how they act**

Definition

□ Composed of two general kinds of Behaviors

◆ Task behaviors

Facilitate goal accomplishment: Help group members **achieve objectives**

◆ Relationship behaviors

Help subordinates feel comfortable with themselves, each other, and the situation

Ohio State Studies

- **Leadership Behavior Description Questionnaire (LBDQ)**
 - Identify number of times leaders engaged in specific behaviors
 - 150 questions
 - Participant settings (military, industrial, educational)
 - Results
 - Particular clusters of behaviors were typical (usual) of leaders

Ohio State Studies, cont'd.

- **LBDQ-XII (Stogdill, 1963)**
 - Shortened version of the LBDQ
 - Most widely used leadership assessment instrument
 - Results - Two general types of leader behaviors:
 - **Initiating structure – Leaders provide structure for subordinates**
 - **Task behaviors** - organizing work, giving structure to the work context, defining role responsibility, scheduling work activities
 - **Consideration - Leaders nurture subordinates**
 - **Relationship behaviors** – building companionship, respect, trust, & liking between leaders & followers

University of Michigan Studies

- **Exploring leadership behavior**
 - Specific emphasis on impact of leadership behavior on performance of **small groups**
- **Results - Two types of leadership behaviors conceptualized as opposite**
 - **Employee orientation**
 - **Strong human relations** emphasis
 - **Production orientation**
 - Stresses the **technical aspects of a job**

Historical Perspective

Blake & Mouton's Managerial Leadership Grid

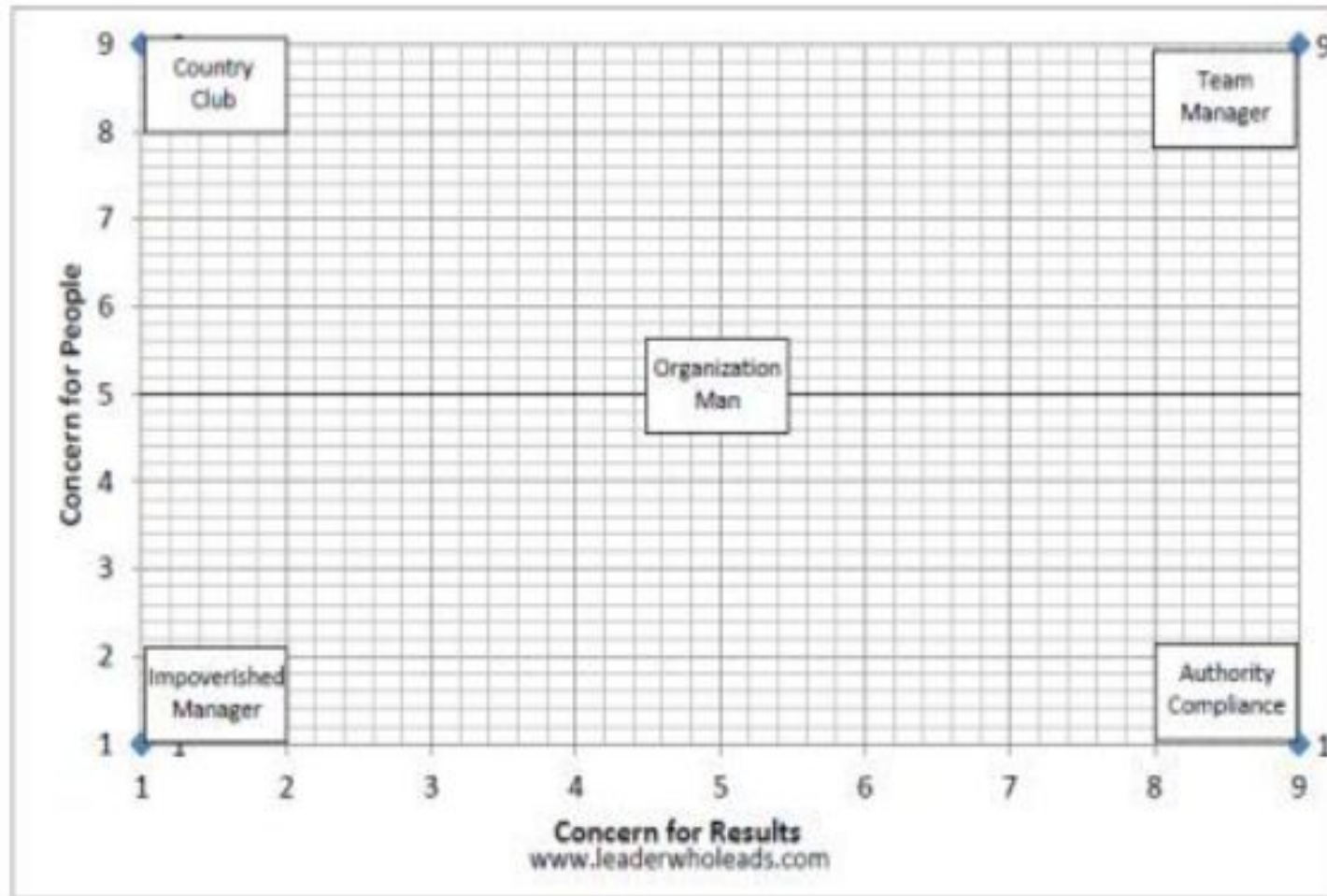
Development

- Developed in early 1960s
- Used extensively in organizational training & development

Purpose

- Designed to explain how leaders help organizations to reach their purposes
 - Two factors
 - Concern for production
 - How a leader is concerned with achieving organizational tasks
 - Concern for people
 - How a leader attends to the members of the organization who are trying to achieve its goals

Example



Authority-Compliance (9,1)

Definition

- **Efficiency in operations** results from arranging conditions of work such that **human interference is minimal**

Role Focus

- **Heavy** emphasis on task and job requirements and *less* emphasis on people
- Communicating with subordinates mainly for task instructions
- **Results driven** – people regarded as tools to that end
- **9,1 leaders** – seen as controlling, demanding, hard-driving, & overpowering

Country Club (1,9)

Definition

- Thoughtful attention to the needs of people leads to a comfortable, friendly organizational atmosphere and work tempo

Role Focus

- **Low** concern for task accomplishment coupled with **high** concern for interpersonal relationships
- **Deemphasizes production**; leaders stress the attitudes and feelings of people
- **1,9 leaders** – try to create a positive climate by **being agreeable, eager to help, comforting, noncontroversial**

Impoverished (1,1)

Definition

- **Minimal effort exerted to get work done** is appropriate to sustain organizational membership

Role Focus

- Leader **unconcerned** with **both task and interpersonal relationships**
- Going through the motions, but **uninvolved** and withdrawn
- **1,1 leaders** – have little contact with followers and are described as indifferent, **noncommittal, resigned, and apathetic**

Middle-of-the-Road (5,5)

Definition

- Adequate organizational performance possible through balancing the necessity of getting work done while maintaining satisfactory morale

Role Focus

- **Leaders who are compromisers; have *intermediate* concern for task and people who do task**
- To achieve equilibrium, leader avoids conflict while emphasizing moderate levels of production and interpersonal relationships
- ***5,5 leader*** – described as expedient; prefers the middle ground; soft-pedals disagreement; swallows convictions in the interest of “progress”

Team (9,9)

Definition

- Work accomplished through committed people; interdependence via a “common stake” in the organization’s purpose, which leads to relationships of trust and respect

Role Focus

- **Strong emphasis on *both* tasks and interpersonal relationships**
- Promotes high degree of participation & teamwork, satisfies basic need of employee to be involved & committed to their work
- **9,9 leader** – stimulates participation, acts determined, makes priorities clear, follows through, behaves open-mindedly and enjoys working

Class Task

- Group discussion (20 minutes)
- Each group will be assigned to discuss on the grids.
- Present the summary (3-4 minutes) by each group leader.